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Global Tech Headlines | 23 October 2026

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01 · GLOBAL TECH NEWS

Ukraine learns to fight without Starlink as Musk plays politics with satellites

Ars Technica · 2026-10-23

Elon Musk’s Starlink satellite service has played a pivotal role in supporting Ukraine’s successful resistance to Russia’s full-scale invasion for years. But with Starlink having become increasingly unreliable due to Musk’s political inclinations and the latest surprise disruptions to service in Ukraine, the Ukrainians and Europe as a whole are now facing urgent questions about how to move forward without it.

As the world’s largest communications satellite network, Starlink can typically support high-speed Internet and data streams for any user or vehicle equipped with a relatively compact Starlink terminal. This has enabled Ukraine to maintain vital communications for both civilian purposes and military operations—and has also expanded the Ukrainian military’s capability to remotely control or provide guidance to drones used in both air defense against Russian attacks and for striking back at

Russian targets.

“Starlink currently offers some of the best satellite coverage available, with virtually no competitors when you consider the combination of cost, availability, and ease of use,” according to the head of hardware R&D at the Ukrainian defense company BlueBird Tech , who provided comments to Ars anonymously for security reasons. “In practical terms, the main limitation is the need to position the antenna so it can receive signals from the satellites.”

Source: https://arstechnica.com/gadgets/2026/10/ukraine-learns-to-fight-without-starlink-as-musk-plays-politics-with-satellites

02 · GLOBAL TECH NEWS

Netflix can’t fire its way out of this downward spiral

The Verge · 2026-10-23

Netflix co-CEOs Ted Sarandos and Greg Peters assured investors this week that they have nothing to be concerned about. Sure, the company was going to lay off 1,000 employees , downsizing its product, tech, and legal departments , and was ousting its chief content officer , film chairman , and film vice president . But it had also hired a new COO — “one of the most effective at-scale operators in the entertainment industry,” Sarandos said — to turn things around.

Though executive shake-ups aren’t uncommon, having so many of them back to back would send a concerning message even in the best of circumstances. With Netflix, however, the situation looks undeniably grim given the streamer’s recent troubles with missed ad revenue targets, sluggish growth, and a failed attempt at acquiring Warner Bros .

Losing WB to David Ellison’s Paramount was a huge blow — that merger would have given Netflix an easy way to expand its catalog, grow its user base, and build a more established presence in movie theaters. The company now has to navigate those challenges on its own while also figuring out why its current content slate hasn’t resulted in record profits.

Sarandos admitted that Netflix needs “better execution” in the US

Source: https://theverge.com/streaming/1017304/netflix-layoffs-bela-bajaria-peter-rice-dan-lin-doug-belgrad

Intel CTO tells Dwarkesh Patel the world lacks tools to 10x chip output

The Next Web · 2026-10-23

Pushkar Ranade, Intel’s chief technology officer

Intel could not make 10 times more leading-edge wafers even if it wanted to, says its chief technology officer, Pushkar Ranade. The world lacks the chipmaking tools. Doubling output is about the limit, he told Dwarkesh Patel on the Dwarkesh Podcast . Patel filmed the episode during a two-day tour of Intel’s most advanced fab in Oregon.

Patel asked whether the world had enough tools for Intel to make 10 times as many leading-edge wafers.

“Not 10X, but probably 2X, yes,” Ranade said.

Patel noted that AI compute has grown about threefold a year for a decade. Ranade said output could only rise faster if every supplier did too.

“Unless everybody produces more, you can’t increase the output,” he said, naming equipment suppliers, their suppliers and their sub-suppliers.

ASML makes fewer than 100 EUV lithography machines a year, Patel said. Intel, TSMC and the memory makers all compete for them. Ranade said EUV is the biggest bottleneck but not the only one, as most chipmaking equipment is in short supply. Once a process like 18A is set, Intel needs the exact tools it was designed for. Intel can reuse about 80% of the 18A tools for the next node, 14A, he said.

Source: https://thenextweb.com/news/intel-cto-ranade-dwarkesh-chip-tools-2x-not-10x

04 · SILICON VALLEY

5 Interesting Startup Deals You May Have Missed: Robot Training, Space Lasers And Greener Cement

Crunchbase News · 2026-10-23

This is a monthly column that runs down five interesting startup funding deals that may have flown under the radar. Check out our previous entry here .

From teaching robots to do everyday household chores to using lasers to track satellites in space, this month’s crop of interesting startup deals spans some decidedly different corners of tech.

Other startups that caught our eye are working on making cement production less polluting, turning agricultural waste into a useful tool for carbon removal, and helping independent video game developers get their product in front of more players. Let’s take a closer look.

Before robots can fold laundry, load dishwashers or prepare meals, they need to learn how humans actually do those things. Maxinsights is betting there’s a big business in supplying the training material.

The Santa Clara, California-based startup this week announced a $30 million seed round led by Peak XV Partners , with participation from Tola Capital , South Park Commons , Ince Capital and Alumni Ventures . The company, founded by veterans of the robotics and autonomous vehicle industries, is building what it calls the data layer for physical AI.

Source: https://news.crunchbase.com/venture/interesting-startup-deals-robots-ai-gaming-clean-tech

05 · THINK TANK WATCH

News shocks and inflation: theory and evidence from large oil discoveries

Bank for International Settlements · 2026-10-23

News Shocks and Inflation: Theory and Evidence
from Large Oil Discoveries *
Bohou Cai Liugang Sheng Hongyan Zhao †
October 12, 2026
Abstract
We study how news shocks affect inflation in open economies, using large oil and gas discoveries with realized production lags of at least five years as observable news about future output. Panel local projections show that discoveries raise core consumer prices over the subsequent decade, with about half the increase occurring prior to extraction.

The response is driven by nontradables, while tradable and producer prices barely respond. The real exchange rate appreciates persistently and real activity expands ahead of extraction, while the current account first deteriorates and then improves as new oil comes online. The inflationary response is concentrated under inflexible exchange-rate regimes but muted under flexible ones.

A three-sector New Keynesian small open-
economy model rationalizes these findings through competing demand and exchange-rate channels, with exchange-rate policy determining which force dominates.
Keywords: News shocks, inflation, oil discoveries, New Keynesian model, small open economy, exchange-rate regimes
JEL: E31, E32, E52, F41, Q32
*We are grateful to Yan Bai, Valerie Ramey, Morten O.

Source: https://bis.org/publications/working-paper-1389-news-shocks-and-inflation-theory-and-evidence-large-oil-discoveries.pdf

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